

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12402583
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 02, 2025
Inventor(s)	Roosenboom-Kooijmans; Maria Helena et al.

Lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ

Abstract

The present invention relates to a *Lactuca sativa* seed designated 45-IC3262 RZ. The present invention also relates to a *Lactuca sativa* plant produced by growing the 45-IC3262 RZ seed. The invention further relates to methods for producing the lettuce cultivar, represented by lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ.

Inventors: Roosenboom-Kooijmans; Maria Helena (De Lier, NL), McMillen; Ryan Joseph (De Lier, NL)

Applicant: RIJK ZWAAN ZAADTEELT EN ZAADHANDEL B.V. (De Lier, NL)

Family ID: 87070412

Assignee: RIJK ZWAAN ZAADTEELT EN ZAADHANDEL B.V. (De Lier, NL)

Appl. No.: 18/149730

Filed: January 04, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20230217877 A1	Jul. 13, 2023

Related U.S. Application Data

us-provisional-application US 63297279 20220107

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: A01H6/14 (20180101); A01H5/12 (20180101)

U.S. Cl.:

Field of Classification Search**USPC:** None**References Cited****U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS**

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
7371930	12/2007	Knerr	N/A	N/A
8809631	12/2013	van Dun	N/A	N/A
9161510	12/2014	Ammerlaan	N/A	N/A
9326479	12/2015	Roosenboom-Kooijmans	N/A	N/A
9370163	12/2015	Moor	N/A	N/A
9554550	12/2016	Roosenboom-Kooijmans	N/A	N/A
10271502	12/2018	Roosenboom-Kooijmans	N/A	A01H 6/1472
10321651	12/2018	Roosenboom-Kooijmans et al.	N/A	N/A
10426117	12/2018	Luijten	N/A	N/A
10492407	12/2018	Tomas Garcia et al.	N/A	N/A
2013/0019336	12/2012	Moor	N/A	N/A
2017/0094930	12/2016	Smits	N/A	N/A
2017/0156283	12/2016	Ammerlaan	N/A	N/A
2019/0037790	12/2018	Morice	N/A	N/A
2019/0098856	12/2018	Kunzemann	N/A	N/A
2019/0141932	12/2018	Roosenboom-Kooijmans et al.	N/A	N/A
2019/0141933	12/2018	Roosenboom-Kooijmans et al.	N/A	N/A
2019/0191653	12/2018	Roosenboom-Kooijmans et al.	N/A	N/A
2019/0364773	12/2018	de Jong	N/A	N/A
2020/0146237	12/2019	Moor	N/A	N/A

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

IBEB press release New race of *Bremia lactucae* 81:27 identified and nominated, May 2010; Plantum NL, Postbus 462, 2800 Al Gouda. cited by applicant

Michelmores R. & Ochoa. O. Breeding Crisphead Lettuce. In: California Lettuce Research Board, Annual Report 2005-2006, 2006, Salinas, California, pp. 55-68. cited by applicant

Schettini, T.M., Legg, E.J., Michelmores. R.W., 1991. Insensitivity to metalaxyl in California populations of *Bremia lactucae* and resistance of California lettuce cultivars to Downy Mildew, Disease Control and Pest Management, pp. 64-70. cited by applicant

Van Ettekenoven, K. et al., Identification and denomination of ‘new’ races of *Bremia lactucae*, In: Lebeda, A. and Kristkova, E (eds.), *Eucarpia Leafy Vegetables*, 1999. cited by applicant

Van der Arend et al. Identification and denomination of “new” races of *Bremia lactucae* in Europe

by IBEB until 2002. In: Van Hintum, Th et al. (eds.), *Eucarpia Leafy Vegetables*. cited by applicant
Cortazar RZ (41-233) Rijk Zwaan AU (Oct. 22, 2019). cited by applicant
Lettuce: Lettuce Resources, Rijk Zwaan AU 2019 (Oct. 22, 2019). cited by applicant
Lalique RZ 44-17—Rijk Zwaan USA and Canada (2018). cited by applicant
UPOV Document TG/244/1 Wild Rocket UPOV Code: DI PLO_TEN *Diplotaxis tenuifolia* (L.)
DC. Date: Apr. 9, 2008. cited by applicant
Beiquan Mou, Review Article: Mutations in Lettuce Improvement, Hindawi Publishing
Corporation, International Journal of Plant Genomics, Nov. 16, 2011) vol. 2011, Article ID 723518,
7 pages. cited by applicant

Primary Examiner: Zhou; Shubo

Assistant Examiner: Byrnes; David R

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Duane Morris LLP

Background/Summary

INCORPORATION BY REFERENCE (1) This application claims priority to U.S. provisional patent application Ser. No. 63/297,279 filed 7 Jan. 2022.

(1) The foregoing applications, and all documents cited therein or during their prosecution (“applied documents”) and all documents cited or referenced in the application cited documents, and all documents cited or referenced herein (“herein cited documents”), and all documents cited or referenced in herein cited documents, together with any manufacturer's instructions, descriptions, product specifications, and product sheets for any products mentioned herein or in any document incorporated by reference herein, are hereby incorporated herein by reference, and may be employed in the practice of the invention. More specifically, all referenced documents are incorporated by reference to the same extent as if each individual document was specifically and individually indicated to be incorporated by reference.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(2) The present invention relates to a new lettuce (*Lactuca sativa*) variety designated 45-IC3262 RZ. Lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ exhibits a combination of traits including resistance to downy mildew (*Bremia lactucae*) races B1:16EU to B1:37EU, and B1:1US to B1:9 US, resistance to currant lettuce aphid (*Nasanovia ribisnigri*) biotype Nr:0, as well as having weak blistered leaves with small blisters.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(3) All cultivated forms of lettuce belong to the highly polymorphic species, *Lactuca sativa*, which is grown for its edible head and leaves. As a crop, lettuces are grown commercially wherever environmental conditions permit the production of an economically viable yield.

(4) *Lactuca sativa* is in the Cichoreae tribe of the Asteraceae (Compositae) family. Lettuce is related to chicory, sunflower, aster, scorzonera, dandelion, artichoke and chrysanthemum. *Sativa* is one of about 300 species in the genus *Lactuca*.

(5) Lettuce cultivars are susceptible to a number of pests and diseases such as downy mildew (*Bremia lactucae*). Every year this disease leads to millions of dollars of lost lettuce crop throughout the world. Downy mildew (*Bremia lactucae*) is highly destructive on lettuce grown at relatively low temperature and high humidity. Downy mildew is caused by a fungus, *Bremia lactucae*, which can be one of the following strains: B1:16EU, B1:17EU, B1:18EU, B1:20EU, B1:21EU, B1:22EU, B1:23EU, B1:24EU, B1:25EU, B1:26EU, B1:27EU, B1:29EU, B1:30EU,

B1:31EU, B1:32EU, B1:33EU, B1:34EU, B1:35EU, B1:36EU, B1:37EU (Van Ettekovén, K. et al., "Identification and denomination of 'new' races of *Bremia lactucae*," In: Lebeda, A. and Kristkova, E (eds.), Eucarpia Leafy Vegetables, 1999, Palacky University, Olomouc, Czech Republic, pp. 171-175; Van der Arend et al. "Identification and denomination of "new" races of *Bremia lactucae* in Europe by IBEB until 2002" In: Van Hintum, Th et al. (eds.), Eucarpia Leafy Vegetables Conference 2003, Centre for Genetic Resources, Wageningen, The Netherlands, p. 151; Plantum NL (Dutch association for breeding, tissue culture, production and trade of seeds and young plants), Van der Arend et al. "Identification and denomination of "new" races of *Bremia lactucae* in Europe by IBEB until 2002." In: Van Hintum, Th et al. (eds.), Eucarpia Leafy Vegetables Conference 2003, Centre for Genetic Resources, Wageningen, The Netherlands, p. 151; Plantum NL; IBEB press release "New race of *Bremia lactucae* B1:27 identified and nominated", May 2010; Plantum NL, IBEB press release, "New races of *Bremia lactucae*, B1:29, B1:30 and B1:31 identified and nominated", August 2013; Plantum NL, IBEB press release, "A new race of *Bremia lactucae*, B1:32 identified and nominated in Europe", May 2015); Plantum NL, IBEB-EU press release, "A new race of *Bremia lactucae*, B1:33EU identified and denominated in Europe", May 2017; Plantum NL, IBEB-EU press release, "Two new races of *Bremia lactucae*, B1:34EU and B1:35EU identified and nominated in Europe", July 2018; Plantum NL, IBEB-EU press release, "A new race of *Bremia lactucae*, B1:36EU identified and denominated in Europe", July 2019; Plantum NL, IBEB EU press release, "A new race of *Bremia lactucae*, B1:37EU identified and denominated in Europe, June 2021), B1:1US, B1:2US, B1:3US, B1:4US, B1:5US, B1:6US, B1:7US, B1:8US, B1:9US (Schettini, T. M., Legg, E. J., Michelmore, R. W., 1991. Insensitivity to metalaxyl in California populations of *Bremia lactucae* and resistance of California lettuce cultivars to downy mildew. *Phytopathology* 81(1). p. 64-70; Michelmore R. & Ochoa. O. "Breeding Crisphead Lettuce, In: California Lettuce Research Board, Annual Report 2005-2006, 2006, Salinas, California, pp. 55-68; http://bremia.ucdavis.edu/data/B1_9US.pdf). Downy mildew causes pale, angular, yellow areas bounded by veins on the upper leaf surfaces. Sporulation occurs on the opposite surface of the leaves. The lesions eventually turn brown, and they may enlarge and coalesce. These symptoms typically occur first on the lower leaves of the lettuce, but under ideal conditions may move into the upper leaves of the head. When the fungus progresses to this degree, the head cannot be harvested. Less severe damage requires the removal of more leaves than usual, especially when the lettuce reaches its final destination. Of the various species of aphids that feed on lettuce, the currant-lettuce aphid (*Nasonovia ribisnigri*) is the most destructive species because it feeds both on the leaves of the lettuce as well as the heart of the lettuce, making it difficult to control with conventional insecticides. The lettuce aphid feeds by sucking sap from the lettuce leaves. Although direct damage to the lettuce may be limited, its infestation has serious consequences because the presence of aphids makes lettuce unacceptable to consumers. Iceberg lettuce is also indicated as crisphead lettuce, although crisphead also involves the Batavia subtype. It is part of *Lactuca sativa* L. (*capitata* Group). Iceberg lettuce is a subtype of cultivated lettuce with large firm heads, giving only slightly to pressure when mature (Ryder E. J., 1998, Lettuce endive, and chicory. CABI publishing, Wallingford, Oxon, UK). The plant passes through a rosette stage at first and the early leaves are elongated; each successive leaf increases in broadness, until they become broader than long when mature. Leaves show no clear midrib, but a flabellate venation. At about 10-12 leaves, a leaf becomes cup-shaped, enclosing the later leaves, which leads to the development of a spherical head. The head continues to enlarge and fill from the inside, until market maturity is reached. Leaf texture varies from highly crisp (Great Lakes group) to less crisp (Salinas-Vanguard group).

(6) A requirement for an iceberg lettuce is that it has a leaf with a good shelf life. This means the leaves should get through the washing and drying process in the factory without bruising or breaking. The leaves should be sufficiently thick and tough to avoid wilting. In addition, the leaves should be blistered enough to avoid sticking to each other and to the plastic of the packaging, which increases local humidity on the leaf and reduces local respiration.

(7) Citation or identification of any document in this application is not an admission that such document is available as prior art to the present invention.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(8) Given the need expressed by relevant stakeholders for a lettuce variety which shows a combination of traits including resistance to downy mildew (*Bremia lactucae*) races B1:16EU to B1:37EU, and B1:1US to B1:9 US, resistance to currant lettuce aphid (*Nasanovia ribisnigri*) biotype Nr:0, as well as having weak blistered leaves with small blisters, the present invention addresses this need by providing a new type of lettuce (*Lactuca sativa*) variety, designated 45-IC3262 RZ.

(9) The present invention provides a new lettuce (*Lactuca sativa*) variety designated 45-IC3262 RZ. This new lettuce variety exhibits a combination of traits including resistance to downy mildew (*Bremia lactucae*) races B1:16EU to B1:37EU, and B1:1US to B1:9 US, resistance to currant lettuce aphid (*Nasanovia ribisnigri*) biotype Nr:0, as well as having weak blistered leaves with small blisters.

(10) The present invention provides seed of a lettuce (*Lactuca sativa*) variety designated 45-IC3262 RZ. A sample of seeds of said lettuce variety, have been deposited with the National Collections of Industrial, Marine and Food Bacteria (NCIMB) in Bucksburn, Aberdeen AB21 9YA, Scotland, UK and have been assigned NCIMB Accession No. 44096.

(11) In one embodiment, the invention provides a lettuce plant grown from the seed of lettuce (*Lactuca sativa*) variety 45-IC3262 RZ.

(12) In another embodiment, the invention provides a lettuce plant designated 45-IC3262 RZ, which is a plant grown from seed having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096.

(13) In one embodiment, the invention provides for a lettuce plant which can comprise genetic information for exhibiting all of the physiological and morphological characteristics of a plant of the invention, wherein the genetic information is as contained in a plant, a sample of seed of said variety having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096.

(14) In one embodiment, the invention provides for a lettuce plant exhibiting all the physiological and morphological characteristics of a plant of the invention, and having the genetic information for so exhibiting the combination of traits, wherein the genetic information is as contained in a plant, a sample of seed of said variety having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096.

(15) In an embodiment of the present invention, there also is provided parts of a lettuce plant of the invention, which may include parts of a lettuce plant exhibiting all the physiological and morphological characteristics of a plant of the invention, or parts of a lettuce plant having any of the mentioned resistance(s) and a combination of traits including one or more or all morphological and physiological characteristics tabulated herein, including parts of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, wherein the plant parts are involved in sexual reproduction, which include, without limitation, microspores, pollen, ovaries, ovules, embryo sacs or egg cells and/or wherein the plant parts are suitable for vegetative reproduction, which include, without limitation, cuttings, roots, stems, cells or protoplasts and/or wherein the plant parts are tissue culture of regenerable cells in which the cells or protoplasts of the tissue culture are derived from a tissue such as, for example and without limitation, leaves, pollen, embryos, cotyledon, hypocotyls, meristematic cells, roots, root tips, anthers, flowers, seeds or stems. The plants of the invention from which such parts may come from include those wherein a sample of seed of which having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096 or lettuce variety or cultivar designated 45-IC3262 RZ, as well as seed from such a plant, plant parts of such a plant (such as those mentioned herein) and plants from such seed and/or progeny of such a plant, advantageously progeny exhibiting such combination of such traits, each of which, is within the scope of the invention; and such combination of traits.

(16) In a further embodiment there is a plant regenerated from the above-described plant parts or regenerated from the above-described tissue culture. Advantageously such a plant may have morphological and/or physiological characteristics of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ and/or of a

plant grown from seed, a sample of seed of which having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096—including without limitation such plants having all of the physiological and morphological characteristics of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ and/or of a plant grown from seed, a sample of seed of which having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096.

(17) Accordingly, in still a further embodiment, there is provided a lettuce plant having all of the physiological and morphological characteristics of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of which having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096. Such a plant may be grown from the seeds, regenerated from the above-described plant parts, or regenerated from the above-described tissue culture. A lettuce plant having any of the aforementioned resistance(s), and one or more morphological or physiological characteristics recited or tabulated herein, and a lettuce plant advantageously having all of the aforementioned resistances and the characteristics recited and tabulated herein, are preferred. Parts of such plants—such as those plant parts above-mentioned—are encompassed by the invention.

(18) In a further aspect, the invention provides a method of vegetatively propagating a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ which can comprise (a) collecting tissue capable of being propagated from a plant of lettuce 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of said variety having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096 and (b) cultivating the tissue to obtain proliferated shoots and rooting the proliferated shoots to obtain rooted plantlets. Optionally the invention further can comprise growing plants from the rooted plantlets. Plantlets and plants produced by these methods, are encompassed by the invention.

(19) In one embodiment, there is provided a method for producing a progeny of lettuce cultivar 45-IC3262 RZ which can comprise crossing a plant designated 45-IC3262 RZ with itself or with another lettuce plant, harvesting the resultant seed, and growing said seed.

(20) In a further embodiment, a progeny plant is provided which is produced by this method, wherein said progeny exhibits a combination of traits including resistance to downy mildew (*Bremia lactucae*) races B1:16EU to B1:37EU, and B1:1US to B1:9 US, resistance to currant lettuce aphid (*Nasanovia ribisnigri*) biotype Nr:0, as well as having weak blistered leaves with small blisters.

(21) In another embodiment, a progeny plant is provided which is produced by the above method, wherein said progeny exhibits all the morphological and physiological characteristics of the lettuce variety designated 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of said variety having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096.

(22) In a further embodiment there is provided a progeny plant produced by sexual or vegetative reproduction, grown from seeds, regenerated from the above-described plant parts, or regenerated from the above-described tissue culture of the lettuce cultivar or a progeny plant thereof, a sample of seed of which having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096. The progeny may have any of the aforementioned resistance(s), and one or more morphological or physiological characteristics recited or tabulated herein, and a progeny plant advantageously having all of the aforementioned resistances and the characteristics recited and tabulated herein, are preferred.

(23) Progeny of the lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ may be modified in one or more other characteristics, in which the modification is a result of, for example and without limitation, mutagenesis or transformation with a transgene.

(24) In still another embodiment, the present invention provides progeny of lettuce cultivar 45-IC3262 RZ produced by sexual or vegetative reproduction, grown from seed, regenerated from the above-described plant parts, or regenerated from the above-described tissue culture of the lettuce cultivar or a progeny plant thereof.

(25) The invention further relates to a method for producing a seed of a 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plant which can comprise (a) crossing a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of which having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096, with a second lettuce plant, and (b) whereby seed of a 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plant forms. This method can

further comprise (c) crossing a plant grown from 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce seed with itself or with a second lettuce plant to yield additional 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce seed, (d) growing the additional 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce seed of step (c) to yield additional 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plants, and (e) repeating the crossing and growing of steps (c) and (d) for an additional 3-10 generations to generate further 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plants, and (f) whereby seed of a 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plant forms. A seed produced by this method and a plant grown from said seed also form part of the invention.

(26) The invention also relates to a method of introducing at least one new trait into a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ which can comprise: (a) crossing a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of which having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096, with a second lettuce plant that can comprise at least one new trait to produce progeny seed, (b) harvesting and planting the progeny seed to produce at least one progeny plant of a subsequent generation, wherein the progeny plant can comprise the at least one new trait, (c) crossing the progeny plant with a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ to produce backcross progeny seed, (d) harvesting and planting the backcross progeny seed to produce a backcross progeny plant, and (e) repeating steps (c) and (d) for at least three additional generations to produce a lettuce plant of variety 45-IC3262 RZ which can comprise at least one new trait and all of the physiological and morphological characteristics of a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, when grown in the same environmental conditions. A lettuce plant produced by this method also forms part of the invention.

(27) Mutations can be introduced randomly by means of one or more chemical compounds, such as ethyl methane sulphonate (EMS), nitrosomethylurea, hydroxylamine, proflavine, N-methyl-N-nitrosoguanidine, N-ethyl-N-nitrosourea, N-methyl-N-nitro-nitrosoguanidine, diethyl sulphate, ethylene imine, sodium azide, formaline, urethane, phenol and ethylene oxide, and/or by physical means, such as UV-irradiation, fast neutron exposure, X-rays, gamma irradiation, and/or by insertion of genetic elements, such as transposons, T-DNA, retroviral elements.

(28) Mutations can also be introduced by more specific, targeted introduction of at least one modification by means of homologous recombination, oligonucleotide-based mutation introduction, zinc-finger nucleases (ZFN), transcription activator-like effector nucleases (TALENs) or Clustered Regularly Interspaced Short Palindromic Repeat (CRISPR) systems.

(29) The invention further relates to a method of producing a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ which can comprise at least one new trait, the method which can comprise introducing a mutation or transgene conferring the at least one new trait into a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, wherein a sample of seed of said variety has been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096. A lettuce plant produced by this method also forms part of the invention.

(30) In still a further embodiment, the invention provides a method of producing a lettuce seed which can comprise crossing a male parent lettuce plant with a female parent lettuce plant and harvesting the resultant lettuce seed, in which the male parent lettuce plant or the female parent lettuce plant is a lettuce plant of the invention, e.g. a lettuce plant having all of the morphological or physiological characteristics tabulated herein, including a lettuce plant of lettuce cultivar 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of which having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096. The resultant lettuce seed produced by this method and the lettuce plant that is produced by growing said lettuce seed also forms part of the invention.

(31) In still a further embodiment, the invention provides a method of producing a lettuce cultivar which exhibits all of the physiological and morphological characteristics of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of said variety having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096.

(32) The invention even further relates to a method of producing lettuce leaves as a food product which can comprise: (a) sowing a seed of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of which having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096, (b) growing said seed into a harvestable lettuce plant and (c) harvesting lettuce leaves or heads from the plant. The invention

further comprehends packaging and/or processing the lettuce plants, heads or leaves.

(33) Also encompassed by the invention is a container which can comprise one or more lettuce plants of the invention for harvest of leaves.

(34) Further encompassed by the invention is a method of determining the genotype of a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of which has been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096, or a first generation progeny thereof, which can comprise obtaining a sample of nucleic acids from said plant and comparing said nucleic acids to a sample of nucleic acids obtained from a reference plant, and detecting a plurality of polymorphisms between the two nucleic acid samples, wherein the plurality of polymorphisms are indicative of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ and/or give rise to the expression of any one or more, or all, of the physiological and morphological characteristics of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ of the invention.

(35) Accordingly, it is an object of the invention to not encompass within the invention any previously known product, process of making the product, or method of using the product such that Applicants reserve the right and hereby disclose a disclaimer of any previously known product, process, or method. It is further noted that the invention does not intend to encompass within the scope of the invention any product, process, or making of the product or method of using the product, which does not meet the written description and enablement requirements of the USPTO (35 U.S.C. § 112, first paragraph), such that Applicants reserve the right and hereby disclose a disclaimer of any previously described product, process of making the product, or method of using the product.

(36) It is noted that in this disclosure and particularly in the claims, terms such as “comprises”, “comprised”, and “comprising” and the like (e.g., “includes”, “included”, “including”, “contains”, “contained”, “containing”, “has”, “had”, “having”, etc.) can have the meaning ascribed to them in US patent law, i.e., they are open ended terms. For example, any method that “comprises,” “has” or “includes” one or more steps is not limited to possessing only those one or more steps and also covers other unlisted steps. Similarly, any plant that “comprises,” “has” or “includes” one or more traits is not limited to possessing only those one or more traits and covers other unlisted traits. Similarly, the terms “consists essentially of” and “consisting essentially of” have the meaning ascribed to them in US patent law, e.g., they allow for elements not explicitly recited, but exclude elements that are found in the prior art or that affect a basic or novel characteristic of the invention. See also MPEP § 2111.03. In addition, the term “about” is used to indicate that a value includes the standard deviation of error for the device or method being employed to determine the value.

(37) These and other embodiments are disclosed or are obvious from and encompassed by the following Detailed Description.

DEPOSIT

(38) The Deposit with NCIMB Ltd, Ferguson Building, Craibstone Estate, Bucksburn, Aberdeen AB21 9YA, UK, on Dec. 21, 2022, under NCIMB Accession number 44096 was made and accepted pursuant to the terms of the Budapest Treaty. Upon issuance of a patent, all restrictions upon the deposit will be removed, and the deposit is intended to meet the requirements of 37 CFR §§ 1.801-1.809. The deposit will be irrevocably and without restriction or condition released to the public upon the issuance of a patent and for the enforceable life of the patent. The deposit will be maintained in the depository for a period of 30 years, or 5 years after the last request, or for the effective life of the patent, whichever is longer, and will be replaced if necessary during that period.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The following detailed description, given by way of example, but not intended to limit the invention solely to the specific embodiments described, may best be understood in conjunction

with the accompanying drawing, in which:

(2) FIG. 1 is an illustration of six different shapes of the fourth leaf from a 20-day old seedling grown under optimal conditions.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

(3) The invention provides methods and compositions relating to plants, seeds and derivatives of a new lettuce variety herein referred to as lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ. Lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ is a uniform and stable line, distinct from other such lines.

(4) In a preferred embodiment, the specific type of breeding method employed for developing a lettuce cultivar is pedigree selection, where both single plant selection and mass selection practices are employed. Pedigree selection, also known as the "Vilmorin system of selection," is described in Fehr, W., Principles of Cultivar Development, Volume I, MacMillan Publishing Co., which is hereby incorporated by reference.

(5) When pedigree selection is applied, in general selection is first practiced among F.sub.2 plants. In the next season, the most desirable F.sub.3 lines are first identified, and then desirable F.sub.3 plants within each line are selected. The following season and in all subsequent generations of inbreeding, the most desirable families are identified first, then desirable lines within the selected families are chosen, and finally desirable plants within selected lines are harvested individually. A family refers to lines that were derived from plants selected from the same progeny from the preceding generation.

(6) Using this pedigree method, two parents may be crossed using an emasculated female and a pollen donor (male) to produce F.sub.1 offspring. Lettuce is an obligate self-pollination species, which means that pollen is shed before stigma emergence, assuring 100% self-fertilization. Therefore, in order to optimize crossing, a method of misting may be used to wash the pollen off prior to fertilization to assure crossing or hybridization.

(7) Parental varieties are selected from commercial varieties that individually exhibit one or more desired phenotypes. Additionally, any breeding method involving selection of plants for the desired phenotype may be used in the method of the present invention.

(8) The F.sub.1 may be self-pollinated to produce a segregating F.sub.2 generation. Individual plants may then be selected which represent the desired phenotype in each generation (F.sub.3, F.sub.4, F.sub.5, etc.) until the traits are homozygous or fixed within a breeding population.

(9) A detailed description of the development of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ is described in Table 1. The seedlot in year 6, seedlot 19R.9262, was deposited with the NCIMB under deposit number 44096.

(10) TABLE-US-00001 TABLE 1 Year Description Location 0 Final F1-cross plant in glasshouse Fijnaart, The Netherlands 1 F1 plant grown for F2 seed Fijnaart, The Netherlands production in glasshouse 2 F2 plant selected in open field, Fijnaart, The Netherlands followed by F3 seed production 3 F3 plant 1selected in open field Murcia, Spain followed by F4 seed production. 4 F4 plant selected in open field Fijnaart, the Netherlands followed by F5 seed production. 5 F5 plant selected in open field Murcia, Spain followed by F6 seed production. 6 F6 line established uniform, Daylesford, Australia multiplied in plastic tunnel; seed lot 19R.9262.

(11) In one embodiment, a plant of the invention has all the physiological and morphological characteristics of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ. These characteristics of a lettuce plant of the invention, e.g. variety 45-IC3262 RZ, are summarized in Table 2.

(12) Next to the physiological and morphological characteristics mentioned in Table 2, a plant of the invention also exhibits resistance to downy mildew (*Bremia lactucae* Regel.) races B1:16EU to B1:37EU, B1:1US to B1:9US.

(13) As used herein resistance against *Bremia lactucae* is defined as the ability of a plant to resist infection by each of the various strains B1:16EU to B1:37EU, B1:1US to B1:9US of *Bremia lactucae* Regel. in all stages between the seedling stage and the harvestable plant stage. B1:16EU to B1:37EU means strains B1:16EU, B1:17EU, B1:18EU, B1:20EU, B1:21EU, B1:22EU,

B1:23EU, B1:24EU, B1:25EU, B1:26EU, B1:27EU, B1:29EU, B1:30EU, B1:31EU, B1:32EU, B1:33EU, B1:34EU, B1:35EU, B1:36EU, B1:37EU (Van Ettehoven K, Van der Arend A J M, 1999. identification and denomination of ‘new’ races of *Bremia lactucae*. In: Lebeda A, Kristkova E (eds.) Eucarpia leafy vegetables '99. Palacky University, Olomouc, Czech Republic, 1999: 171-175; Van der Arend, A. J. M., Gautier, J., Guenard, M., Michel, H., Moreau, B., de Ruijter, J., Schut, J. W. and de Witte, I. (2003). Identification and denomination of ‘new’ races of *Bremia lactucae* in Europe by IBEB until 2002. In: Eucarpia leafy vegetables 2003. Proceedings of the Eucarpia Meeting on leafy vegetables genetics and breeding. Noorwijkerhout, The Netherlands. Eds. Van Hintum T., Lebeda A., Pink D., Schut J. pp 151-160; Van der Arend A J M, Gautier J, Grimault V, Kraan P, Van der Laan R, Mazet J, Michel H, Schut J W, Smilde D, De Witte I (2006) Identification and denomination of “new” races of *Bremia lactucae* in Europe by IBEB until 2006; incorporated herein by reference; Plantum NL (Dutch association for breeding, tissue culture, production and trade of seeds and young plants), IBEB press release, “New race of *Bremia lactucae* B1:27 identified and nominated”, May 2010; Plantum NL, IBEB press release, “New races of *Bremia lactucae*, B1:29, B1:30 and B1:31 identified and nominated”, August 2013; Plantum NL, IBEB press release, “A new race of *Bremia lactucae*, B1:32 identified and nominated in Europe”, May 2015; Plantum NL, IBEB-EU press release, “A new race of *Bremia lactucae*, B1:33EU identified and denominated in Europe”, May 2017; Plantum NL, IBEB-EU press release, “Two new races of *Bremia lactucae*, B1:34EU and B1:35EU identified and nominated in Europe”, July 2018; Plantum NL, IBEB-EU press release, “A new race of *Bremia lactucae*, B1:36EU identified and denominated in Europe”, July 2019; Plantum NL, IBEB EU press release, “A new race of *Bremia lactucae*, B1:37EU identified and denominated in Europe, June 2021). B1:1US to B1:9US means B1:1US, B1:2US, B1:3US, B1:4US, B1:5US, B1:6US, B1:7US, B1:8US, B1:9US (Schettini, T. M., Legg, E. J., Micheltmore, R. W., 1991. Insensitivity to metalaxyl in California populations of *Bremia lactucae* and resistance of California lettuce cultivars to downy mildew, Phytopathology 81(1). p. 64-70; Micheltmore R. & Ochoa. O. “Breeding Crisphead Lettuce.” In: California Lettuce Research Board, Annual Report 2005-2006, 2006, Salinas, California, pp. 55-68; http://bremia.ucdavis.edu/data/B1_9US.pdf).

(14) Resistance typically is tested by two interchangeable methods, described by Bonnier, F. J. M. et al. (Euphytica, 61(3):203-211, 1992; incorporated herein by reference). One method involves inoculating 7-day old seedlings, and observing sporulation 10 to 14 days later. The other method involves inoculating leaf discs with a diameter of 18 mm obtained from a non-senescent, fully grown true leaf and observing sporulation 10 days later.

(15) As used herein, resistance against *Nasonovia ribisnigri* (Mosley), or currant-lettuce aphid, is defined as the plant characteristic which results in a non-feeding response of the aphid on the leaves of the plant in all stages between 5 true-leaf stage and harvestable plant stage (U.S. Pat. No. 5,977,443 to Jansen, J. P. A., “Aphid Resistance in Composites,” p. 12, 1999; incorporated herein by reference).

(16) Resistance is tested by spreading at least ten aphids of biotype Nr:0 on a plant in a plant stage between 5 true leaves and harvestable stage, and observing the density of the aphid population on the plant as well as the growth reduction after 14 days in a greenhouse, with temperature settings of 23 degrees Celsius in daytime and 21 degrees Celsius at night. Day length is kept at 18 hours by assimilation lights.

(17) As used herein, blistering is defined in the UPOV guidelines Lettuce (TG/13/11) as blistering of the mature leaf of the lettuce plant (Char. 18 in the TG/13/11). An absent or very weak blistering of the mature leaves is defined as having a similar or comparable blistering as the lettuce variety Duplex, or Sartre, when grown under the same environmental conditions. A very strong blistering the mature leaves is further defined as Blonde de Doulon, Iride or Karioka, when grown under the same environmental conditions. Lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ shows a weak blistering, which is more blistering then comparison variety Regnas RZ which shows absent or very weak blistering.

(18) Embodiments of the inventions advantageously have one or more, and most advantageously all, of these characteristics.

(19) In Table 2, the characteristics of “45-IC3262 RZ” are shown.

(20) TABLE-US-00002 TABLE 2 SEED Seed Color Black PLANT Plant: Head Diameter Medium to large Plant: Degree of Overlapping of Upper Strong Part of Leaves LEAF Leaf: Leaf Attitude Semi-erect Leaf: Number of Divisions Absent or very few Leaf: Shape Medium oblate Leaf: Shape of Apex Rounded Leaf: Longitudinal Section Flat Leaf: Anthocyanin Coloration Absent or very weak Leaf: Color Green Leaf: Intensity of Green Color Light to medium Leaf: Glossiness of Upper Side Weak to medium Leaf Thickness Thick Leaf: Blistering Weak Leaf: Size of Blisters Small Leaf: Undulation of Margin Weak Leaf: Type of Incisions of Margin Irregularly dentate Leaf: Depth of Incisions of Margin Shallow Leaf: Depth of Secondary Incisions of Very shallow to Margin shallow Leaf: Density of Incisions of Margin Sparse to medium Leaf: Venation Flabellate HEAD Head: Size Medium to Large Head: Shape in Longitudinal Section Circular Head: Density Dense to very Dense HARVEST Time of Harvest Maturity Medium to late BOLTING Bolting: Time of Beginning of Bolting Very late Auxilliary Sprouting Absent or weak Bolting: Bolting Stem: Fasciation Absent or very weak PLANT TYPE Plant Type Iceberg type COTYLEDON TO FOURTH LEAF STAGE Shape of Cotyledons Intermediate Shape of Fourth Leaf Elongated PLANT Plant head Diameter 17 cm.sup. Plant Spread of Frame Leaves 49 Plant Number of Leaves — LEAF Leaf: Number of Divisions 1 BUTT Butt: Shape Rounded Butt: Midrib Prominently raised HARVEST MATURITY Time of harvest Maturity 97 Days

(21) In one aspect the invention provides a new type of lettuce (*Lactuca sativa*) variety, designated 45-IC3262 RZ. Lettuce cultivar 45-IC3262 RZ exhibits a combination of traits including resistance to downy mildew (*Bremia lactucae*) races B1:16EU to B1:37EU, and B1:1US to B1:9 US, resistance to currant lettuce aphid (*Nasanovia ribisnigri*) biotype Nr:0, as well as having weak blistered leaves with small blisters.

(22) In an embodiment, the invention relates to lettuce plants that have all the physiological and morphological characteristics of the invention and have acquired said characteristics by introduction of the genetic information that is responsible for the characteristics from a suitable source, either by conventional breeding, or genetic modification, in particular by cisgenesis or transgenesis. Cisgenesis is genetic modification of plants with a natural gene, coding for an (agricultural) trait, from the crop plant itself or from a sexually compatible donor plant. Transgenesis is genetic modification of a plant with a gene from a non-crossable species or a synthetic gene.

(23) Just as useful traits that may be introduced by backcrossing, useful traits may be introduced directly into the plant of the invention, being a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, by genetic transformation techniques; and, such plants of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ that have additional genetic information introduced into the genome or that express additional traits by having the DNA coding there for introduced into the genome via transformation techniques, are within the ambit of the invention, as well as uses of such plants, and the making of such plants.

(24) Genetic transformation may therefore be used to insert a selected transgene into the plant of the invention, being a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ or may, alternatively, be used for the preparation of transgenes which may be introduced by backcrossing. Methods for the transformation of plants, including lettuce, are well known to those of skill in the art.

(25) Vectors used for the transformation of lettuce cells are not limited so long as the vector may express an inserted DNA in the cells. For example, vectors which can comprise promoters for constitutive gene expression in lettuce cells (e.g., cauliflower mosaic virus 35S promoter) and promoters inducible by exogenous stimuli may be used. Examples of suitable vectors include pBI binary vector. The “lettuce cell” into which the vector is to be introduced includes various forms of lettuce cells, such as cultured cell suspensions, protoplasts, leaf sections, and callus. A vector may be introduced into lettuce cells by known methods, such as the polyethylene glycol method,

polycation method, electroporation, *Agrobacterium*-mediated transfer, particle bombardment and direct DNA uptake by protoplasts. To effect transformation by electroporation, one may employ either friable tissues, such as a suspension culture of cells or embryogenic callus or alternatively one may transform immature embryos or other organized tissue directly. In this technique, one would partially degrade the cell walls of the chosen cells by exposing them to pectin-degrading enzymes (pectolyases) or mechanically wound tissues in a controlled manner.

(26) A particularly efficient method for delivering transforming DNA segments to plant cells is microprojectile bombardment. In this method, particles are coated with nucleic acids and delivered into cells by a propelling force. Exemplary particles include those which may be comprised of tungsten, platinum, and preferably, gold. For the bombardment, cells in suspension are concentrated on filters or solid culture medium. Alternatively, immature embryos or other target cells may be arranged on solid culture medium. The cells to be bombarded are positioned at an appropriate distance below the macroprojectile stopping plate. An illustrative embodiment of a method for delivering DNA into plant cells by acceleration is the Biolistics Particle Delivery System, which may be used to propel particles coated with DNA or cells through a screen, such as a stainless steel or Nytex screen, onto a surface covered with target lettuce cells. The screen disperses the particles so that they are not delivered to the recipient cells in large aggregates. It is believed that a screen intervening between the projectile apparatus and the cells to be bombarded reduces the size of projectiles aggregate and may contribute to a higher frequency of transformation by reducing the damage inflicted on the recipient cells by projectiles that are too large.

Microprojectile bombardment techniques are widely applicable, and may be used to transform virtually any plant species, including a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ.

(27) *Agrobacterium*-mediated transfer is another widely applicable system for introducing gene loci into plant cells. An advantage of the technique is that DNA may be introduced into whole plant tissues, thereby bypassing the need for regeneration of an intact plant from a protoplast.

Agrobacterium transformation vectors are capable of replication in *E. coli* as well as *Agrobacterium*, allowing for convenient manipulations. Moreover, advances in vectors for *Agrobacterium*-mediated gene transfer have improved the arrangement of genes and restriction sites in the vectors to facilitate the construction of vectors capable of expressing various polypeptide coding genes. The vectors have convenient multi-linker regions flanked by a promoter and a polyadenylation site for direct expression of inserted polypeptide coding genes. Additionally, *Agrobacterium* containing both armed and disarmed Ti genes may be used for transformation. In those plant strains where *Agrobacterium*-mediated transformation is efficient, it is the method of choice because of the facile and defined nature of the gene locus transfer. The use of *Agrobacterium*-mediated plant integrating vectors to introduce DNA into plant cells, including lettuce plant cells, is well known in the art (See, e.g., U.S. Pat. Nos. 7,250,560 and 5,563,055).

(28) Transformation of plant protoplasts also may be achieved using methods based on calcium phosphate precipitation, polyethylene glycol treatment, electroporation, and combinations of these treatments.

(29) A number of promoters have utility for plant gene expression for any gene of interest including but not limited to selectable markers, scoreable markers, genes for pest tolerance, disease resistance, nutritional enhancements and any other gene of agronomic interest. Examples of constitutive promoters useful for lettuce plant gene expression include, but are not limited to, the cauliflower mosaic virus (CaMV) P-35S promoter, a tandemly duplicated version of the CaMV 35S promoter, the enhanced 35S promoter (P-e35S), the nopaline synthase promoter, the octopine synthase promoter, the figwort mosaic virus (P-FMV) promoter (see U.S. Pat. No. 5,378,619), an enhanced version of the FMV promoter (P-eFMV) where the promoter sequence of P-FMV is duplicated in tandem, the cauliflower mosaic virus 19S promoter, a sugarcane bacilliform virus promoter, a commelina yellow mottle virus promoter, the promoter for the thylakoid membrane proteins (psaD, psaF, psaE, PC, FNR, atpC, atpD, cab, rbcS) (see U.S. Pat. No. 7,161,061), the

CAB-1 promoter (see U.S. Pat. No. 7,663,027), the promoter from maize prolamin seed storage protein (see U.S. Pat. No. 7,119,255), and other plant DNA virus promoters known to express in plant cells. A variety of plant gene promoters that are regulated in response to environmental, hormonal, chemical, and/or developmental signals may be used for expression of an operably linked gene in plant cells, including promoters regulated by (1) heat, (2) light (e.g., pea rbcS-3A promoter, maize rbcS promoter, or chlorophyll a/b-binding protein promoter), (3) hormones, such as abscisic acid, (4) wounding (e.g., wun1, or (5) chemicals such as methyl jasmonate, salicylic acid, or Safener. It may also be advantageous to employ organ-specific promoters.

(30) Exemplary nucleic acids which may be introduced to the lettuce variety of this invention include, for example, DNA sequences or genes from another species, or even genes or sequences which originate with or are present in lettuce species, but are incorporated into recipient cells by genetic engineering methods rather than classical reproduction or breeding techniques. However, the term “exogenous” is also intended to refer to genes that are not normally present in the cell being transformed, or perhaps simply not present in the form, structure, etc., as found in the transforming DNA segment or gene, or genes which are normally present and that one desires to express in a manner that differs from the natural expression pattern, e.g., to over-express. Thus, the term “exogenous” gene or DNA is intended to refer to any gene or DNA segment that is introduced into a recipient cell, regardless of whether a similar gene may already be present in such a cell. The type of DNA included in the exogenous DNA may include DNA which is already present in the plant cell, DNA from another plant, DNA from a different organism, or a DNA generated externally, such as a DNA sequence containing an antisense message of a gene, or a DNA sequence encoding a synthetic or modified version of a gene.

(31) Many hundreds if not thousands of different genes are known and could potentially be introduced into a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ. Non-limiting examples of particular genes and corresponding phenotypes one may choose to introduce into a lettuce plant include one or more genes for insect tolerance, pest tolerance such as genes for fungal disease control, herbicide tolerance, and genes for quality improvements such as yield, nutritional enhancements, environmental or stress tolerances, or any desirable changes in plant physiology, growth, development, morphology or plant product(s).

(32) Alternatively, the DNA coding sequences may affect these phenotypes by encoding a non-translatable RNA molecule that causes the targeted inhibition of expression of an endogenous gene, for example via antisense- or cosuppression-mediated mechanisms. The RNA could also be a catalytic RNA molecule (i.e., a ribozyme) engineered to cleave a desired endogenous mRNA product. Thus, any gene which produces a protein or mRNA which expresses a phenotype or morphology change of interest is useful for the practice of the present invention (See also U.S. Pat. No. 7,576,262, “Modified gene-silencing RNA and uses thereof.”).

(33) U.S. Pat. Nos. 7,230,158, 7,122,720, 7,081,363, 6,734,341, 6,503,732, 6,392,121, 6,087,560, 5,981,181, 5,977,060, 5,608,146, 5,516,667, each of which, and all documents cited therein are hereby incorporated herein by reference, consistent with the above INCORPORATION BY REFERENCE section, are additionally cited as examples of U.S. patents that may concern transformed lettuce and/or methods of transforming lettuce or lettuce plant cells, and techniques from these US patents, as well as promoters, vectors, etc., may be employed in the practice of this invention to introduce exogenous nucleic acid sequence(s) into a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ (or cells thereof), and exemplify some exogenous nucleic acid sequence(s) which may be introduced into a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ (or cells thereof) of the invention, as well as techniques, promoters, vectors etc., to thereby obtain further plants of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, plant parts and cells, seeds, other propagation material harvestable parts of these plants, etc. of the invention, e.g. tissue culture, including a cell or protoplast, such as an embryo, meristem, cotyledon, pollen, leaf, anther, root, root tip, pistil, flower, seed or stalk.

(34) The invention further relates to propagation material for producing plants of the invention.

Such propagation material can comprise inter alia seeds of the claimed plant and parts of the plant that are involved in sexual reproduction. Such parts are for example selected from the group consisting of seeds, microspores, pollen, ovaries, ovules, embryo sacs and egg cells. In addition, the invention relates to propagation material which can comprise parts of the plant that are suitable for vegetative reproduction, for example cuttings, roots, stems, cells, protoplasts.

(35) According to a further aspect thereof the propagation material of the invention can comprise a tissue culture of the claimed plant. The tissue culture can comprise regenerable cells. Such tissue culture may be derived from leaves, pollen, embryos, cotyledon, hypocotyls, meristematic cells, roots, root tips, anthers, flowers, seeds and stems. (See generally U.S. Pat. No. 7,041,876 on lettuce being recognized as a plant that may be regenerated from cultured cells or tissue).

(36) Also, the invention comprehends methods for producing a seed of a “45-IC3262 RZ”-derived lettuce plant which can comprise (a) crossing a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of which having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096, with a second lettuce plant, and (b) whereby seed of a 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plant form. Such a method can further comprise (c) crossing a plant grown from 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce seed with itself or with a second lettuce plant to yield additional 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce seed, (d) growing the additional 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce seed of step (c) to yield additional 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plants, and (e) repeating the crossing and growing of steps (c) and (d) for an additional 3-10 generations to further generate 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plants.

(37) The invention further relates to the above methods that can further comprise selecting at steps b), d), and e), a 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plant, exhibiting one or more or all of the physiological and morphological characteristics of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of said variety having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096, and other selected traits.

(38) In particular, the invention relates to methods for producing a seed of a 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plant which can comprise (a) crossing a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of which having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096, with a second lettuce plant and (b) whereby seed of a 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plant forms, wherein such a method can further comprise (c) crossing a plant grown from 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce seed with itself or with a second lettuce plant to yield additional 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce seed, (d) growing the additional 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce seed of step (c) to yield additional 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plants and selecting plants exhibiting one or more or all of the physiological and morphological characteristics of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, and (e) repeating the crossing and growing of steps (c) and (d) for an additional 3-10 generations to further generate 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plants that exhibit one or more or all of the physiological and morphological characteristics of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ.

(39) The invention additionally provides a method of introducing at least one new trait into a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ which can comprise: (a) crossing a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of which having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096, with a second lettuce plant that can comprise at least one new trait to produce progeny seed; (b) harvesting and planting the progeny seed to produce at least one progeny plant of a subsequent generation, wherein the progeny plant can comprise the at least one new trait; (c) crossing the selected progeny plant with a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, to produce backcross progeny seed; (d) harvesting and planting the backcross progeny seed to produce a backcross progeny plant, (e) repeating steps (c) and (d) for at least three additional generations to produce backcross progeny that can comprise the at least one new trait and all of the physiological and morphological characteristics of a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, when grown in the same environmental conditions. The invention, of course, includes a lettuce plant produced by this method.

(40) Backcrossing may also be used to improve an inbred plant. Backcrossing transfers a specific desirable trait from one inbred or non-inbred source to an inbred that lacks that trait. This may be

accomplished, for example, by first crossing a superior inbred (A) (recurrent parent) to a donor inbred (non-recurrent parent), which carries the appropriate locus or loci for the trait in question. The progeny of this cross are then mated back to the superior recurrent parent (A) followed by selection in the resultant progeny for the desired trait to be transferred from the non-recurrent parent. After five or more backcross generations with selection for the desired trait, the progeny are heterozygous for loci controlling the characteristic being transferred, but are like the superior parent for most or almost all other loci. The last backcross generation would be selfed to give pure breeding progeny for the trait being transferred. When a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of which having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096, is used in backcrossing, offspring retaining one or more or all of the physiological and morphological characteristics of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ are progeny within the ambit of the invention. Backcrossing methods may be used with the present invention to improve or introduce a characteristic into a plant of the invention, being a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ. See, e.g., U.S. Pat. No. 7,705,206 (incorporated herein by reference consistent with the above INCORPORATION BY REFERENCE section), for a general discussion relating to backcrossing.

(41) The invention further involves a method of determining the genotype of a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of which has been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096, or a first generation progeny thereof, which can comprise obtaining a sample of nucleic acids from said plant and detecting in said nucleic acids a plurality of polymorphisms. This method may additionally comprise the step of storing the results of detecting the plurality of polymorphisms on a computer readable medium. The plurality of polymorphisms are indicative of and/or give rise to the expression of the physiological and morphological characteristics of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ.

(42) There are various ways of obtaining genotype data from a nucleic acid sample. Genotype data may be gathered which is specific for certain phenotypic traits (e.g. gene sequences), but also patterns of random genetic variation may be obtained to construct a so-called DNA fingerprint. Depending on the technique used a fingerprint may be obtained that is unique for lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ. Obtaining a unique DNA fingerprint depends on the genetic variation present in a variety and the sensitivity of the fingerprinting technique. A technique known in the art to provide a good fingerprint profile is called AFLP fingerprinting technique (See generally U.S. Pat. No. 5,874,215), but there are many other marker based techniques, such as RFLP (or Restriction fragment length polymorphism), SSLP (or Simple sequence length polymorphism), RAPD (or Random amplification of polymorphic DNA) VNTR (or Variable number tandem repeat), Microsatellite polymorphism, SSR (or Simple sequence repeat), STR (or Short tandem repeat), SFP (or Single feature polymorphism) DArT (or Diversity Arrays Technology), RAD markers (or Restriction site associated DNA markers) (e.g. Baird et al. PloS One Vol. 3 e3376, 2008; Semagn et al. African Journal of Biotechnology Vol. 5 number 25 pp. 2540-2568, 29 December, 2006). Nowadays, sequence-based methods are utilizing Single Nucleotide Polymorphisms (SNPs) that are randomly distributed across genomes, as a common tool for genotyping (e.g. Elshire et al. PloS One Vol. 6: e19379, 2011; Poland et al. PloS One Vol. 7: e32253; Truong et al. PLoS One Vol. 7 number 5: e37565, 2012).

(43) With any of the aforementioned genotyping techniques, polymorphisms may be detected when the genotype and/or sequence of the plant of interest is compared to the genotype and/or sequence of one or more reference plants. As used herein, the genotype and/or sequence of a reference plant may be derived from, but is not limited to, any one of the following: parental lines, closely related plant varieties or species, complete genome sequence of a related plant variety or species, or the de novo assembled genome sequence of one or more related plant varieties or species. For example, it is possible to detect polymorphisms for the characteristic of *Bremia* resistance by comparing the genotype and/or the sequence of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ with the genotype and/or the sequence of one or more reference plants. The reference plant(s) used for comparison in this

example may for example be, but is not limited to, the comparison variety Regnas RZ.

(44) The polymorphism revealed by these techniques may be used to establish links between genotype and phenotype. The polymorphisms may thus be used to predict or identify certain phenotypic characteristics, individuals, or even species. The polymorphisms are generally called markers. It is common practice for the skilled artisan to apply molecular DNA techniques for generating polymorphisms and creating markers.

(45) The polymorphisms of this invention may be provided in a variety of mediums to facilitate use, e.g. a database or computer readable medium, which may also contain descriptive annotations in a form that allows a skilled artisan to examine or query the polymorphisms and obtain useful information.

(46) As used herein “database” refers to any representation of retrievable collected data including computer files such as text files, database files, spreadsheet files and image files, printed tabulations and graphical representations and combinations of digital and image data collections. In a preferred aspect of the invention, “database” refers to a memory system that may store computer searchable information.

(47) As used herein, “computer readable media” refers to any medium that may be read and accessed directly by a computer. Such media include, but are not limited to: magnetic storage media, such as floppy discs, hard disc, storage medium and magnetic tape; optical storage media such as CD-ROM; electrical storage media such as RAM, DRAM, SRAM, SDRAM, ROM; and PROMs (EPROM, EEPROM, Flash EPROM), and hybrids of these categories such as magnetic/optical storage media. A skilled artisan may readily appreciate how any of the presently known computer readable mediums may be used to create a manufacture which can comprise computer readable medium having recorded thereon a polymorphism of the present invention.

(48) As used herein, “recorded” refers to the result of a process for storing information in a retrievable database or computer readable medium. For instance, a skilled artisan may readily adopt any of the presently known methods for recording information on computer readable medium to generate media which can comprise the polymorphisms of the present invention. A variety of data storage structures are available to a skilled artisan for creating a computer readable medium where the choice of the data storage structure will generally be based on the means chosen to access the stored information. In addition, a variety of data processor programs and formats may be used to store the polymorphisms of the present invention on computer readable medium.

(49) The present invention further provides systems, particularly computer-based systems, which contain the polymorphisms described herein. Such systems are designed to identify the polymorphisms of this invention. As used herein, “a computer-based system” refers to the hardware, software and memory used to analyze the polymorphisms. A skilled artisan may readily appreciate that any one of the currently available computer-based system are suitable for use in the present invention.

(50) Lettuce leaves are sold in packaged form, including without limitation as pre-packaged lettuce salad or as lettuce heads. Mention is made of U.S. Pat. No. 5,523,136, incorporated herein by reference consistent with the above INCORPORATION BY REFERENCE section, which provides packaging film, and packages from such packaging film, including such packaging containing leafy produce, and methods for making and using such packaging film and packages, which are suitable for use with the lettuce leaves of the invention. Thus, the invention comprehends the use of and methods for making and using the leaves of the lettuce plant of the invention, as well as leaves of lettuce plants derived from the invention. The invention further relates to a container which can comprise one or more plants of the invention, or one or more lettuce plants derived from a plant of the invention, in a growth substrate for harvest of leaves from the plant in a domestic environment. This way the consumer may pick very fresh leaves for use in salads. More generally, the invention includes one or more plants of the invention or one or more plants derived from lettuce of the invention, wherein the plant is in a ready-to-harvest condition, including with the consumer picking

his own, and further including a container which can comprise one or more of these plants.

(51) The invention is further described by the following numbered paragraphs:

(52) 1. A seed of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of said variety having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096.

(53) 2. A lettuce plant grown from the seed of paragraph 1.

(54) 3. A lettuce plant, or a part thereof, having all the physiological and morphological characteristics of the lettuce plant of paragraph 2.

(55) 4. A part of the lettuce plant of paragraph 2, wherein said part comprises a microspore, pollen, ovary, ovule, embryo sac, egg cell, cutting, root, stem, cell or protoplast.

(56) 5. A tissue culture of regenerable cells or protoplasts from the lettuce plant of paragraph 2.

(57) 6. The tissue culture as in paragraph 6, wherein said cells or protoplasts of the tissue culture are derived from a tissue comprising a leaf, pollen, embryo, cotyledon, hypocotyl, meristematic cell, root, root tip, anther, flower, seed or stem.

(58) 7. A lettuce plant regenerated from the tissue culture of paragraph 5 or 6, wherein the regenerated plant expresses all of the physiological and morphological characteristics of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of said variety having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096.

(59) 8. A method of vegetatively propagating a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ comprising (a) collecting tissue capable of being propagated from a lettuce plant of paragraph 2, (b) cultivating the tissue to obtain proliferated shoots and rooting the proliferated shoots to obtain rooted plantlets, and (c) optionally growing plants from the rooted plantlets.

(60) 9. A method for producing a progeny plant of lettuce cultivar 45-IC3262 RZ, comprising crossing a lettuce plant of paragraph 2 with itself or with another lettuce plant, harvesting the resultant seed, and growing said seed.

(61) 10. A progeny plant produced by the method of paragraph 9, wherein said progeny exhibits all the morphological and physiological characteristics of the lettuce variety designated 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of said variety having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096.

(62) 11. The progeny plant as in paragraph 10, wherein said progeny plant is modified in one or more other characteristics.

(63) 12. A lettuce plant of paragraph 2 further comprising a transgene.

(64) 13. The plant as in paragraph 12, wherein the transgene is introduced via transformation.

(65) 14. A method for producing a modified lettuce plant comprising mutagenizing the seed of paragraph 1 and growing said seed.

(66) 15. A method for producing a modified lettuce plant comprising mutagenizing the plant of any one of paragraphs 2, 3 or 7.

(67) 16. A method for producing a modified lettuce plant comprising mutagenizing the part of plant of any one of paragraphs 3 or 4.

(68) 17. A method for producing a modified lettuce plant comprising mutagenizing the tissue culture of any one of paragraphs 5 or 6.

(69) 18. A method of producing a lettuce seed comprising crossing a male parent lettuce plant with a female parent lettuce plant and harvesting the resultant lettuce seed, wherein said male parent lettuce plant or said female parent lettuce plant is the lettuce plant of paragraph 2.

(70) 19. An F1 lettuce seed produced by the method of paragraph 18.

(71) 20. A lettuce plant produced by growing the seed of paragraph 19.

(72) 21. A method for producing a seed of a 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plant comprising (a) crossing a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of which having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096, with a second lettuce plant, and (b) whereby seed of a 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plant forms.

(73) 22. The method of paragraph 21 further comprising (c) crossing a plant grown from 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce seed with itself or with a second lettuce plant to yield additional 45-

IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce seed, (d) growing the additional 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce seed of step (c) to yield additional 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plants, and (e) repeating the crossing and growing of steps (c) and (d) for an additional 3-10 generations to generate further 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plants, and (f) whereby seed of a 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plant forms.

(74) 23. A method of introducing at least one new trait into a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ comprising: (a) crossing a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of which having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096, with a second lettuce plant that comprises at least one new trait to produce progeny seed, (b) harvesting and planting the progeny seed to produce at least one progeny plant of a subsequent generation, wherein the progeny plant comprises the at least one new trait, (c) crossing the progeny plant with a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ to produce backcross progeny seed, (d) harvesting and planting the backcross progeny seed to produce a backcross progeny plant, and (e) repeating steps (c) and (d) for at least three additional generations to produce a lettuce plant of variety 45-IC3262 RZ comprising at least one new trait and all of the physiological and morphological characteristics of a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, when grown in the same environmental conditions.

(75) 24. The lettuce plant produced by the method of paragraph 23, wherein the plant comprises the at least one new trait and otherwise all of the physiological and morphological characteristics of a lettuce plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ.

(76) 25. A method for producing lettuce leaves as a food product comprising sowing the seed of paragraph 1 and growing the seed into a harvestable lettuce plant and harvesting the head or leaves of said plant, optionally processing and/or packaging the head or the leaves.

(77) 26. A container comprising one or more lettuce plants of paragraph 2 for harvest of leaves.

(78) Having thus described in detail preferred embodiments of the present invention, it is to be understood that the invention is not to be limited to particular details set forth in the above description as many apparent variations thereof are possible without departing from the spirit or scope of the present invention.

Claims

1. A seed of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of said variety having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096.
2. A lettuce plant grown from the seed of claim 1.
3. A lettuce plant, or a part thereof, having all the physiological and morphological characteristics of the lettuce plant of claim 2.
4. A part of the lettuce plant of claim 2, wherein said part comprises a leaf, cotyledon, hypocotyl, meristematic cell, microspore, pollen, ovary, ovule, embryo, embryo sac, egg cell, cutting, root, root tip, anther, flower, stem, cell, seed or protoplast.
5. A tissue culture of regenerable cells or protoplasts from the lettuce plant of claim 2.
6. A lettuce plant regenerated from the tissue culture of claim 5, wherein the regenerated plant expresses all of the physiological and morphological characteristics of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of said variety having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096.
7. A method of vegetatively propagating a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ comprising (a) collecting tissue capable of being propagated from the lettuce plant of claim 2, (b) cultivating the tissue to obtain proliferated shoots and rooting the proliferated shoots to obtain rooted plantlets, and (c) optionally growing plants from the rooted plantlets.
8. A method for producing a progeny plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of said variety having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096, comprising crossing the lettuce plant of claim 2 with itself or with another lettuce plant, harvesting the resultant seed, and growing said seed.
9. A progeny plant produced by the method of claim 8, wherein said progeny exhibits all the

morphological and physiological characteristics of the lettuce variety designated 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of said variety having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096.

10. A lettuce plant grown from a seed of lettuce variety 45-IC3261 RZ, a sample of seed of said variety having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096, further comprising a transgene.
 11. The plant as claimed in claim 10, wherein the transgene is introduced via transformation.
 12. A method for producing a modified lettuce plant comprising mutagenizing the seed of claim 1 and growing said seed.
 13. A method for producing a modified lettuce plant comprising mutagenizing the plant of claim 2 or 3.
 14. A method for producing a modified lettuce plant comprising mutagenizing the part of plant of claim 3 or 4.
 15. A method for producing a modified lettuce plant comprising mutagenizing the tissue culture of claim 5.
 16. A method of producing a lettuce seed comprising crossing a male parent lettuce plant with a female parent lettuce plant and harvesting the resultant lettuce seed, wherein said male parent lettuce plant or said female parent lettuce plant is the lettuce plant of claim 2.
 17. An F1 lettuce seed produced by the method of claim 16.
 18. A lettuce plant produced by growing the seed of claim 17.
 19. A method for producing a seed of a 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plant comprising (a) crossing a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, a sample of seed of which having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096, with a second lettuce plant, and (b) whereby seed of a 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plant forms.
 20. The method of claim 19 further comprising (c) crossing a plant grown from 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce seed with itself or with a second lettuce plant to yield additional 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce seed, (d) growing the additional 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce seed of step (c) to yield additional 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plants, and (e) repeating the crossing and growing of steps (c) and (d) for an additional 3-10 generations to generate further 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plants, and (f) whereby seed of a 45-IC3262 RZ-derived lettuce plant forms.
 21. A method of introducing at least one new trait into a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ comprising: (a) crossing the lettuce plant of claim 2, a sample of seed of which having been deposited under NCIMB Accession No. 44096, with a second lettuce plant that comprises at least one new trait to produce progeny seed, (b) harvesting and planting the progeny seed to produce at least one progeny plant of a subsequent generation, wherein the progeny plant comprises the at least one new trait, (c) crossing the progeny plant with a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ to produce backcross progeny seed, (d) harvesting and planting the backcross progeny seed to produce a backcross progeny plant, and (e) repeating steps (c) and (d) for at least three additional generations to produce a lettuce plant of variety 45-IC3262 RZ comprising at least one new trait and all of the physiological and morphological characteristics of a plant of lettuce variety 45-IC3262 RZ, when grown in the same environmental conditions.
 22. A method for producing lettuce leaves as a food product comprising sowing the seed of claim 1 and growing the seed into a harvestable lettuce plant and harvesting the head or leaves of said plant, optionally processing and/or packaging the head or the leaves.
 23. A container comprising the lettuce plant of claim 2 for harvest of leaves.
-